

Maddison Erbabian

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Department of Economics, University of California San Diego, La Jolla, CA 92093

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, University of California San Diego 2022 - present
Fields: Development, Macroeconomics, and Labor
Advisors: Gaurav Khanna (co-chair), Tom Vogl (co-chair), Titan Alon, Gordon Dahl, Munseob Lee
B.A., Economics, High Honors, Mount Holyoke College 2020
Honors Thesis: “Educational Spillovers of Higher Education Institutions in the Developing World: Case Studies in Sub-Saharan Africa”

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

“Higher Education Expansion, Human Capital Formation, and Structural Transformation”
“Gender Gaps and Cross-Country Heterogeneity in the Effects of Higher Education Expansion”
“Risky Moves: Labor Market Risk & Migratory Decisions”
with Steven Brownstone and Marina Perrupato Mendonca

WORKING PAPERS

“Love in the Time of Zika”
with C. Austin Davis, Gaurav Khanna, and Margaret J. Lay

EARLY STAGE WORK

“General Equilibrium Effects of a Positive Return to Schooling Shock”
“The Effects of Migration Frictions and School Locations on Intergenerational Mobility”
with Idaliya Grigoryeva

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, & GRANTS

Women’s Work in Markets of the 21st Century Small Research Grant, STEG & G ² LM LIC	2025-2026
NBER Doctoral Fellowship Runner Up, NBER Gender in the Economy Working Group	2026
Virginia Galbraith Graduate Fellowship for Excellence in Economics, Mount Holyoke College	2025
Excellence in Graduate Teaching Award as a Top 5 TA, UC San Diego Economics Department	2024-2025
Summer Research Fellowship, UC San Diego Economics Department	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
Research & Travel Grant, UC San Diego Economics Department	2025, 2026
Regents Fellowship, UC San Diego	2022-2023
Diversity Research Fellowship, UC San Diego Economics Department	2022
Phoebe Tulman Perlman Prize for the Best Thesis, Mount Holyoke College Economics Department	2020
Mary Lyon Scholar Award for an Exceptional Thesis, Mount Holyoke College	2020
Fiscal Policy Fellowship, Peter G. Peterson Foundation	2019
Economics & Public Policy Fellowship, The Fund for American Studies	2019
California Seal of Biliteracy (French), State of California	2015

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant for Gaurav Khanna, Margaret J. Lay, and C. Austin Davis, UC San Diego	2024
Research Associate at Penn Wharton Budget Model (PWBM), University of Pennsylvania	2020-2022
Research Assistant for Douglas Holtz-Eakin and Gordon Gray, American Action Forum	2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor for Intermediate Macroeconomics: Long-Run Growth, UC San Diego	2026
Teaching Assistant for Macroeconomics, Econometrics, and Masters Thesis courses, UC San Diego	2023-Present

SERVICE & ACTIVITIES

Undergraduate-Graduate Economics Research Lab, Graduate Student Advisor, UC San Diego	2024-Present
Backstory Podcast: How Research Papers in Economics Get Made, Co-host, UC San Diego	2024-Present
Economics PhD Peer Mentorship Program (COMRADES), Peer Mentor, UC San Diego	2023-2025

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

NBER Gender in the Economy PhD Mentorship Workshop, NBER Summer Institute	2026
West Coast Micro to Macro Development Workshop, UC San Diego	2026
Economics PhD Research Symposium, Mount Holyoke College	2025
<i>Upcoming:</i>	
STEG Annual Conference & Theme Workshops, University of Manchester	2027

SELECTED POLICY WRITING

Labor and Education

(coauthored with Efraim Berkovich, Daniela Viana Costa, Youran Wu, Austin Herrick, Victoria Osorio)

“Total Cost of Universal Pre-K, Including New Facilities,” <i>Penn Wharton Budget Model (PWBM)</i>	2022
“The Decline in Fertility: The Role of Marriage and Education,” <i>PWBM</i>	2022
“Covid-19 Learning Loss: Long-run Macroeconomic Effects Update,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“Economic Effects from Preschool and Childcare Programs,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“COVID-19 School Closures: Long-run Macroeconomic Effects,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“COVID-19: Cost of Virtual Schooling by Race and Income,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“School Reopening During COVID-19: A Cost-Benefit Analysis for Philadelphia Suburbs,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“COVID: Trade-Offs in School Reopening,” <i>PWBM</i>	2020

Fiscal Policy

(coauthored with Jon Huntley, John Ricco, Efraim Berkovich, Richard Prisinzano, Alexander Arnon, Marcos Dinerstein, Youran Wu, Gordon Gray)

“H.R. 5376, Build Back Better Act: Budget and Macroeconomic Effects,” <i>PWBM</i>	2022
“Macroeconomic Effects of the White House Build Back Better Budget Reconciliation Framework,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“Senators Manchin and Schumer’s 2021 Senate Budget Reconciliation Agreement: Macroeconomic and Distributional Effects,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“The Macroeconomic Effects of the August 2021 Budget Reconciliation Package,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“President Biden’s FY2022 Budget Proposal: Budgetary and Economic Effects,” <i>PWBM</i>	2021
“What If the Federal Government Hits the Debt Limit?” <i>American Action Forum</i>	2019